

Topic 13: AI Content Strategy and Planning

13.1 Where AI Helps in Content Strategy

- AI accelerates the research and ideation phases of content strategy -- not the strategic thinking itself
- AI input: audience persona drafts, competitor content analysis, topic ideation, content gap identification
- Human input: business goals, brand positioning, budget, distribution channels, editorial judgement
- Output: content calendar, defined content pillars, and a measurement framework
- Warning: AI-generated strategy reflects patterns in its training data, not knowledge of your specific business or audience

13.2 Audience Persona Development

- Prompt: 'Create 3 audience personas for a B2B SaaS product for HR managers. Include: role, company size, pain points, goals, content preferences, and key objections.'
- Use your actual customer data as input: describe your best and worst customers to the AI
- Validate AI personas against real customer interviews and sales call notes -- AI creates plausible templates, not verified insights
- Apply personas in every content prompt: 'Write this for Persona 2: the time-pressed HR generalist at a 200-person company'

13.3 Content Calendar with AI

- Prompt: 'Create a 4-week content calendar for a [industry] company targeting [audience]. Include 3 blog posts, 12 LinkedIn posts, 4 email newsletters. Themes: [your themes].'
- AI generates a calendar with titles, formats, and suggested dates
- Layer in what AI cannot know: company events, product launches, speaking engagements, and industry dates
- Batch creation session: block a half-day, use AI to generate first drafts of all planned content in one sitting
- Scheduling tools: Buffer (buffer.com), Later (later.com), or Hootsuite (hootsuite.com) for scheduling and analytics

13.4 Measuring Content Performance

- Define KPIs before creating: traffic, time on page, social shares, email click-through rate, leads, conversions
- AI can suggest relevant KPIs: 'What metrics should I track for a B2B content programme focused on generating inbound leads?'

- Post-mortem prompts: 'This article had a high bounce rate. Based on the content, what might explain this?'
 - Paste analytics data into AI for analysis: 'Here is last month's blog performance data. What patterns do you see?'
 - Monthly review habit: paste top and bottom performers and ask AI to identify patterns and suggest improvements
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